

india report.

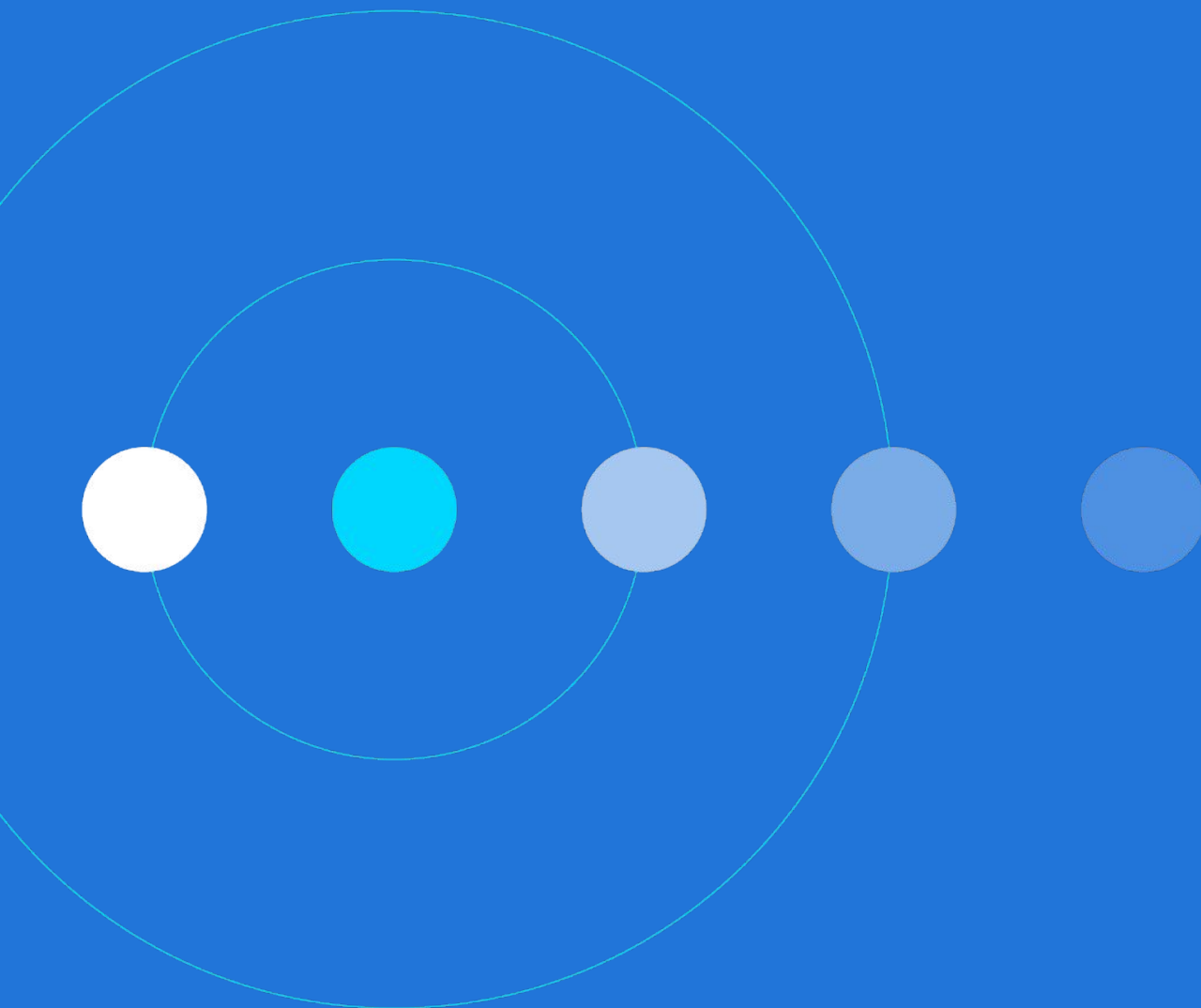
employer brand research 2026



randstad **KANTAR**



partner for talent.



03 executive summary

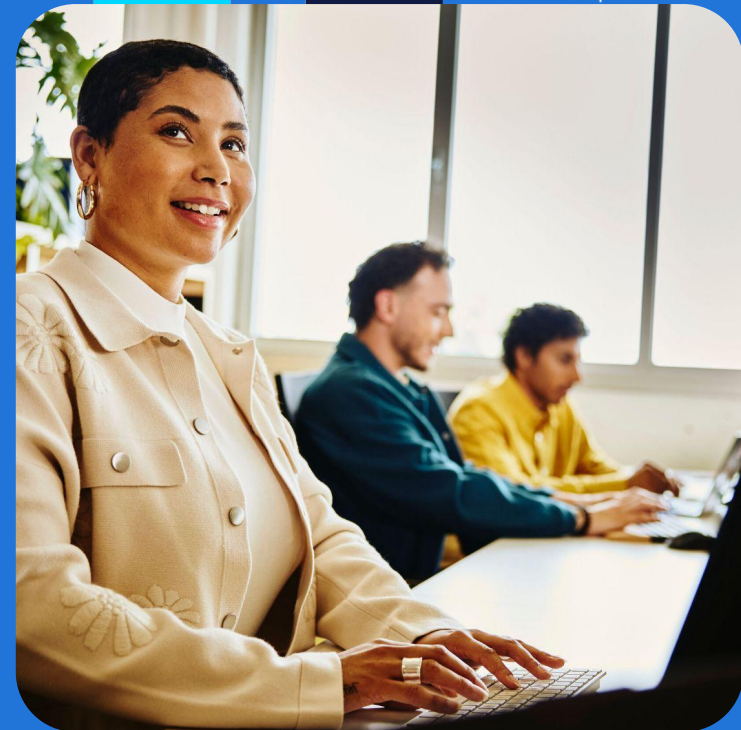
10 key drivers

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20 job-switching behaviour

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executive summary.



employers deliver strongly on fairness, growth and credibility, but salary remains the clearest gap.

A good work-life balance is the most important driver of employer choice in India, closely followed by equal opportunities, career progression, salary and benefits, and very good reputation. Together, these top five drivers combine day-to-day support, fairness, growth, reward and credibility, pointing to a balanced employer offer rather than a single dominant need. Salary and benefits and work-life balance also stand out as the most prioritised drivers when trade-offs are made, with career progression close behind, showing that reward, balance and growth are the core expectations talent are least willing to compromise on.

While employers perform well on very good reputation, equal opportunities and career progression, gaps are more visible in salary and benefits, which remains one of the key ideal-employer drivers despite a comparatively weaker current-employer showing. Work-life balance is also highly important and rated positively, but sits behind credibility, fairness and growth as a current employer strength.

In general, generational and gender differences are limited, though some patterns do emerge. Millennials place slightly greater emphasis on work-life balance, salary and benefits, and employer reputation, while younger talent overall value equal opportunities and career progression somewhat more than older talent. The importance of career progression and reputation also increases with education level, while equal opportunities is particularly important to women and higher educated talent. Gender gaps are otherwise small, with men and women showing broadly similar priorities across the main drivers.

51%

of Gen X look for strong management/leadership in an ideal employer.

61%

of women look for equal opportunities in an ideal employer, compared with 57% of men.

job security, benefits and work-life balance in India are shaped by career continuity, development and day-to-day support.

Job security in India is built on a mix of recognition, continuity and financial reassurance. Performance recognition and career continuity, together with reliable pay and benefits, form the strongest foundations, while transparent communication also plays an important supporting role. The pattern is broadly shared, but its meaning shifts by career stage: older talent place more emphasis on reliable pay and benefits (~52% vs. ~46%), while younger talent are more likely to link security to recognition, continuity and future employability. Gender differences are limited, though women place slightly more weight on development and employability (44% vs. 40%).

Secondary benefits reinforce this wider sense of security by extending support beyond pay alone. In India, all major benefit categories are rated as highly important, with career and development benefits leading a tightly grouped set of practical and wellbeing-focused benefits. Differences are driven mainly by career stage rather than gender, with Millennials and Gen X placing greater importance than Gen Z on the leading benefits, suggesting that wider benefits becomes more important over time.

Work-life balance in India is shaped primarily by the everyday work experience. A good work environment stands out as the key driver, followed by personal growth and fulfilment, with flexible work arrangements and health and wellbeing support forming the next tier. Generations are largely aligned, though personal growth becomes more important with age, while women place slightly more emphasis on flexible work arrangements.

92%

of Millennials value career and development benefits, compared with 86% of Gen Z and 91% of Gen X.

37%

of women link work-life balance to flexible work arrangements, compared with 33% of men.

mobility pressure remains high in India, with work-life balance, career growth and compensation driving retention risk.

46%

of talent plan to change jobs in the next six months, compared with 32% who changed employer in the last six months.

43%

of Millennials would leave due to a lack of career growth opportunities, compared with 42% in Gen Z and 39% Gen X.

Talent's intention to change jobs in India remains well ahead of actual recent switching behaviour, showing that mobility pressure continues to outpace movement. With almost half of talent considering a move, retention risk is driven less by realised exits and more by unmet expectations that keep switching intentions elevated.

Work-life balance is the strongest trigger for leaving, followed by career growth and low compensation, making balance, progression and reward the core pressure points. This is particularly notable because work-life balance (49%) and career growth (42%) are also rated strongly for current employers (both 80%), suggesting that even well-performing areas can still drive exits when expectations are high. By contrast, salary and benefits aligns more clearly with a weaker-performing area, making it one of the clearest structural gaps. Employers perform more positively on reputation, leadership and fairness, while management and leadership are also rated well overall (82%), even if poor relationships with management still prompt some talent to leave.

Generational differences are limited but directionally consistent. Younger talent are slightly more likely than Gen X to leave due to work-life balance concerns (~51% vs. 46%), while Millennials place somewhat greater emphasis on career growth (43%). Compensation is remarkably steady across generations (~41%), indicating that fair reward is a broadly shared expectation rather than a life-stage-specific concern. Gender differences are also small. Women are slightly more likely than men to cite work-life balance as a reason to leave, while men place marginally more emphasis on career growth and compensation, reinforcing that the overall pattern of retention pressure is broadly similar across groups.

job search in India spans digital, formal and social routes, but LinkedIn and Google for Jobs remain the strongest pathways into employment

50%

of Millennials found a job through Google for Jobs, compared with 46% of Gen Z and 36% of Gen X.

personal connections/referrals

in India are more used by younger generations (41% for Gen Z vs. 38% for Millennials) than older talent (~35%) as a means to look for a job.

When exploring new opportunities, talent in India use a digital mix of channels, with LinkedIn leading, followed by Google for Jobs. Company career websites and job boards form the next layer, showing that employer-led and structured platforms still play an important role alongside broader digital search.

Looking more closely at the platforms behind this, Naukri and Indeed are the leading job portals for both search and job finding, while LinkedIn and Instagram are the strongest social media channels. X and Snapchat are more often mentioned as places where talent found jobs than as places where they actively searched, suggesting these platforms serve more as passive discovery channels.

Search behaviour also differs by generation. Millennials are strongest on LinkedIn (69% vs. 68% Gen Z and 61% Gen X), Google for Jobs (59% vs. 58% and 49%), company career websites (52% vs. 48% and 38%) and job boards (49% vs. 43% and 37%). Together, this points to a job search journey that is digital-led in reach but still shaped by structured platforms and personal contact at key decision points.

As talent move through the job search journey, in-person contact remains highly important (85%), reinforcing a process that is digital-first in reach but still human-supported at key decision points.

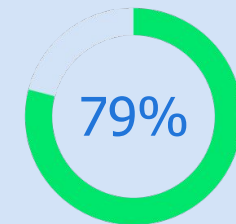
specializations.

expectations across operational and professional specializations are broadly similar, but digital talent show stronger reward needs.

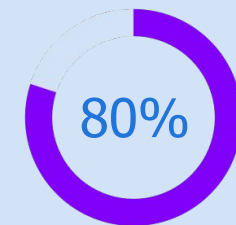
Across specializations, core expectations are broadly similar; work-life balance, equal opportunities, career progression and competitive salary all rank strongly, yet digital talent prioritizes competitive salary (73%) before good work-life balance (64%) and equal opportunities (61%), while operational talent gives more importance to equality (61%) before work-life balance (58%) and strong management also slightly surpassing good reputation.

Evaluation of the current employer is broadly similar for operational and professional talent, agreeing on ranking good reputation as the first driver (both 85%), followed by strong management (both 83%) and equal opportunities (~83%). Digital talent on the contrary gives greater credit to the employer's offer of equal opportunity (80%), followed by easy access to work (80%) and job security (79%).

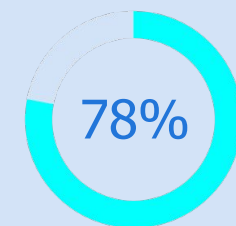
Retention pressure is also more growth-led for digital talent. They are more likely to leave due to lack of career growth opportunities (55% vs. 40% operational and 43% professional), and they are also more likely to use company career websites when looking for jobs (64% vs. 49% for both groups). Together, this points to a more opportunity-driven mindset among digital talent, who place greater emphasis on career progression, active job seeking and a stronger overall employment proposition, while operational and professional talent show a more balanced and stable set of expectations.



operational



professional



digital

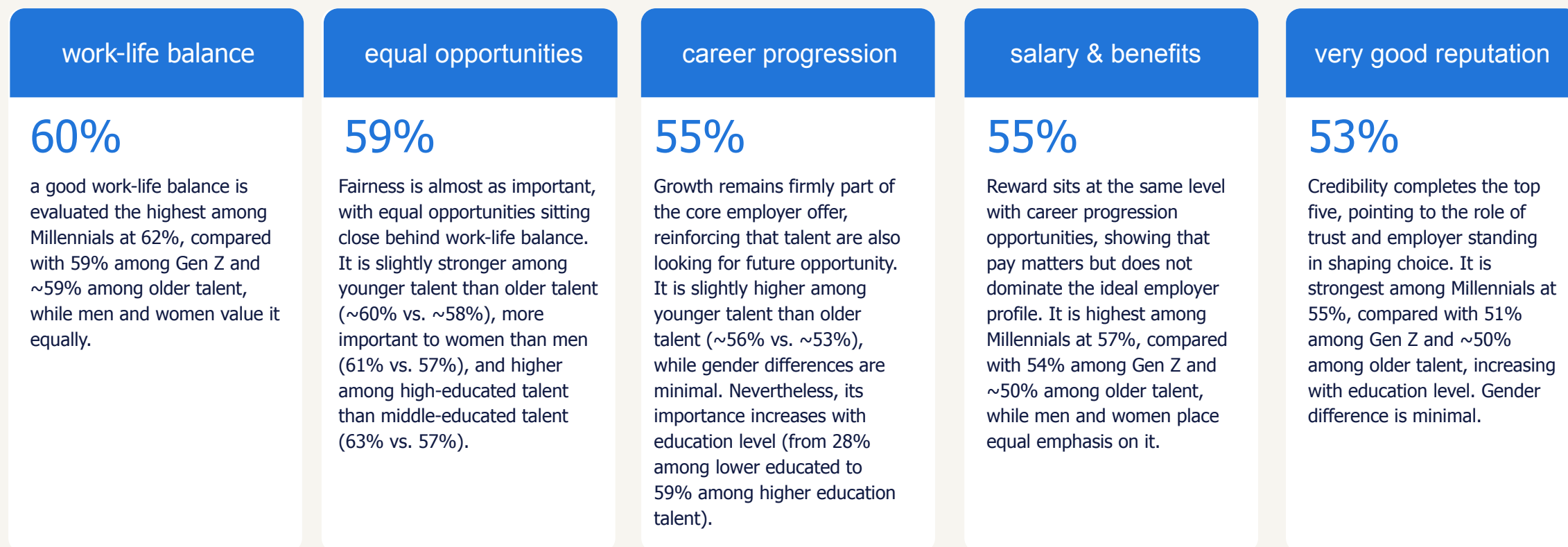
rate their employer positively on
fostering a very good atmosphere.

key drivers.



top five reasons employees choose an employer.

a good work-life balance is the strongest driver of employer choice in India, with equal opportunities following closely behind. Career progression opportunities, competitive salary and benefits, and very good reputation complete a tightly grouped top five. Together, these priorities suggest that talent value a balanced employer offer built around day-to-day support, fairness, growth, reward and credibility.



explanation key drivers' relative priority.



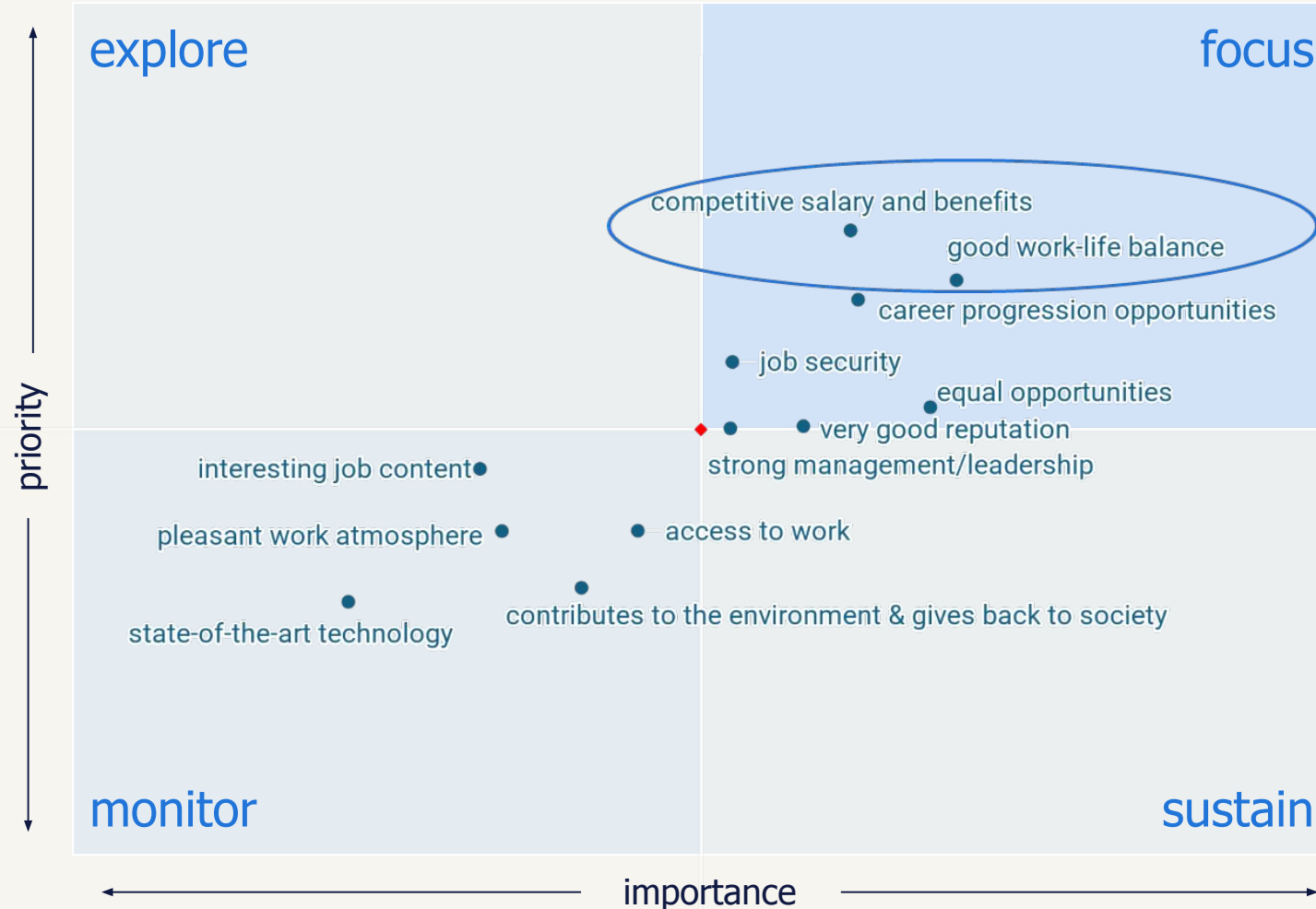
Higher-ranked drivers indicate greater importance or preference compared to those lower down, showing relative priorities.

This table illustrates both the absolute importance and the relative priority of the EVP drivers. Depending on their relationships, each driver falls into a different quadrant, and each quadrant provides distinct actionable insights.



Q. Based on your previous selections, please rank the most important factors that an ideal employer should have, in order of importance.

key drivers' relative priority.



In India, competitive salary and benefits, alongside good work-life balance, stand out as the clearest focus drivers, combining broad importance with stronger priority when trade-offs are made. Career progression opportunities also sit close to this space, suggesting that reward, balance and growth are the core expectations talent are least willing to compromise on.

Job security, equal opportunities and very good reputation remain important, but are less strongly prioritised, suggesting they are more likely to support employer choice once the core expectations around reward, balance and progression are met.

how do employees evaluate their current employer versus ideal?

in India, the current employer profile partly reflects the ideal employer, with the clearest gap sitting in salary and benefits.

evaluation of current employer

1. very good reputation
2. strong management/leadership
3. easy access to work
4. equal opportunities
5. career progression
6. work-life balance
7. job security
8. interesting job content
9. pleasant work atmosphere
10. salary & benefits
11. state-of-the-art technology
12. benefits the environment and society

profile of ideal employer

1. work-life balance
2. equal opportunities
3. career progression
4. salary & benefits
5. very good reputation
6. job security
7. strong management/leadership
8. easy access to work
9. benefits the environment and society
10. pleasant work atmosphere
11. interesting job content
12. state-of-the-art technology

Very good reputation is the strongest current-employer asset, with 85% rating their employer positively. Equal opportunities and career progression opportunities are also well supported, suggesting that employers in India are seen as credible, fair and able to offer growth.

The main tension sits around competitive salary and benefits. It remains one of the key ideal-employer drivers at 55% but is less prominent in the current employer profile despite a positive rating of 78%. Good work-life balance is different: it leads the ideal employer profile at 60% and is also rated strongly in the current employer view at 80%.

Overall, the current employer profile is strong, but weighted more toward credibility, fairness and growth than reward.



key driver deepdive.



elements that reinforce a strong sense of job security.

performance recognition and career continuity, together with reliable pay and benefits, are the strongest foundations of job security in India.

which elements most significantly contribute to a strong sense of job security?



Transparent and trustworthy communication follows close behind, showing that job security in India is shaped not only by recognition and financial reassurance, but also by whether talent feel informed and supported by the organisation. Learning, development and employability comes next, adding a future-facing dimension to job security.

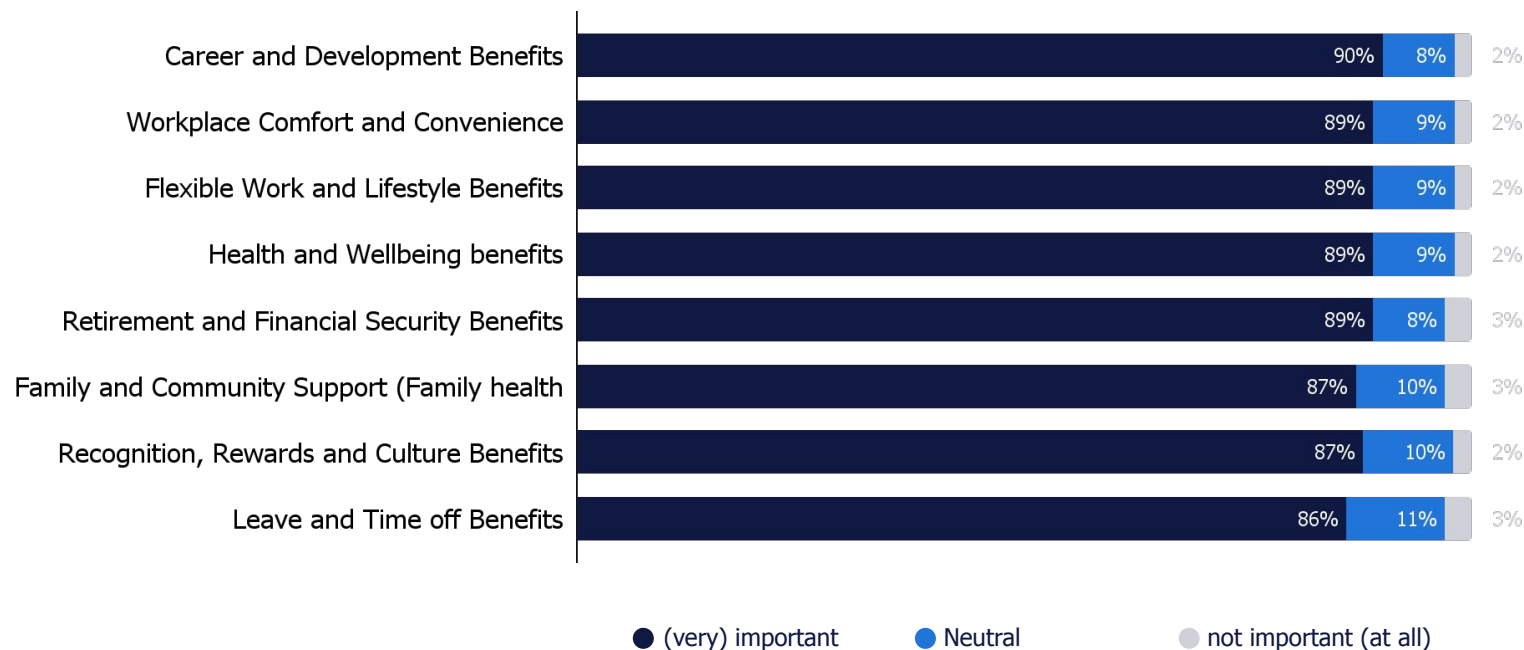
Generationally, older talent place more emphasis on reliable pay and benefits (~52% vs. ~46%), while younger talent are more likely to connect job security to performance recognition and career continuity (~47% vs. ~39%). Learning, development and employability also decline from Gen Z to Millennials and Gen X (45%, 43%, 38%), suggesting that younger talent look more to future growth as part of feeling secure.

Gender differences are smaller, though women place more weight on learning, development, and employability than men (44% vs. 40%).

most important secondary benefits.

all the secondary benefits are viewed as highly important across in India, with career and development benefits leading slightly ahead of a tightly grouped set of practical and wellbeing-focused benefits.

importance of secondary benefits



The main differences appear by career stage. Millennials and Gen X place more importance than Gen Z on the leading benefits, including career and development (~92% vs. 86%), workplace comfort (~90% vs. 85%), flexible work (~90% vs. 85%) and health and wellbeing (~91% vs. 86%) This suggests that secondary benefits become more important as talent move further into their careers.

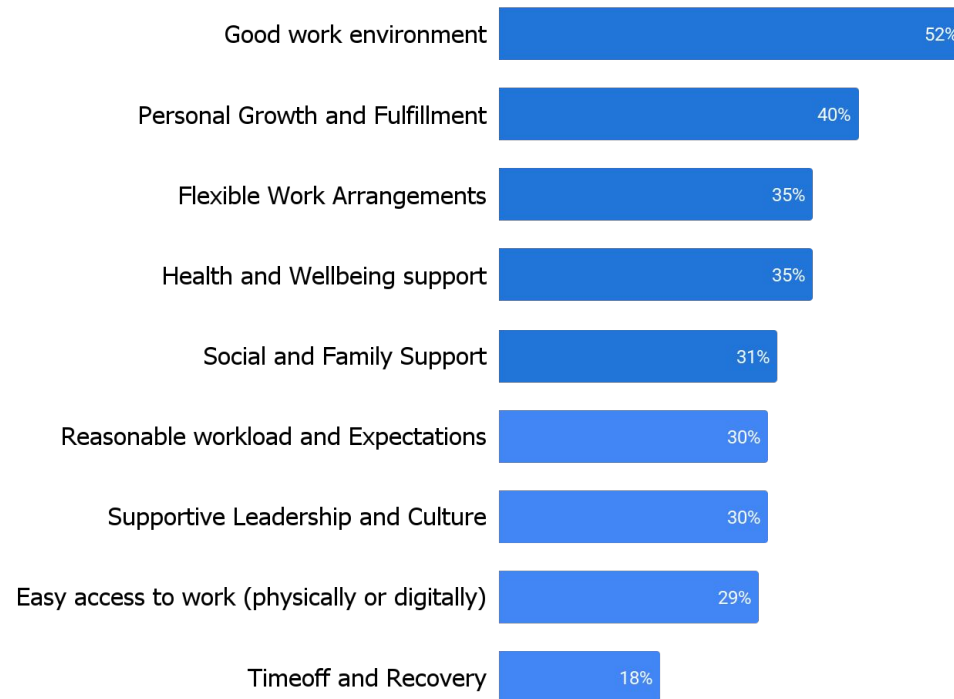
Gender differences are minimal across the leading benefits, pointing to broad consistency in what men and women expect from the wider benefits offer.



elements that strengthen work-life balance.

a good work environment is the key driver to a good work-life balance in India, followed by personal growth and fulfillment.

which elements most significantly enhance a healthy work-life balance?



Flexible work arrangements and health and wellbeing support form the next tier. Together, this suggests that work-life balance in India depends on a positive environment, meaningful work, flexibility and day-to-day support.

A good work environment is valued consistently across generations, at 51% among Gen Z and Millennials and 53% among Gen X. What shifts with career stage is the added role of personal growth and fulfilment, which rises to 45% among Gen X versus 40% among Gen Z and 39% among Millennials, indicating that balance becomes more tied to meaningful work over time.

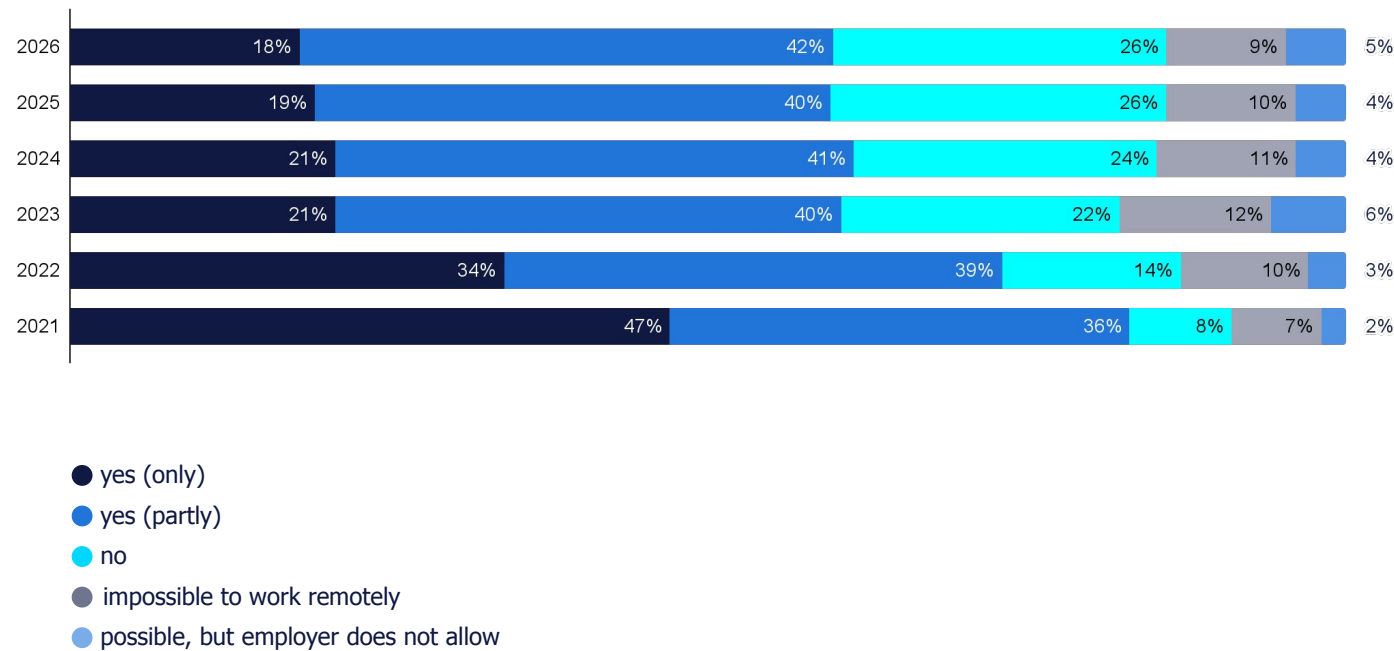
Gender differences are limited, although men place slightly more weight on personal growth and fulfilment (42% vs. 39%), while women place more weight on flexible work arrangements (37% vs. 33%).



trend in remote working.

remote working remains widely embedded in India, mainly through hybrid work rather than fully remote roles.

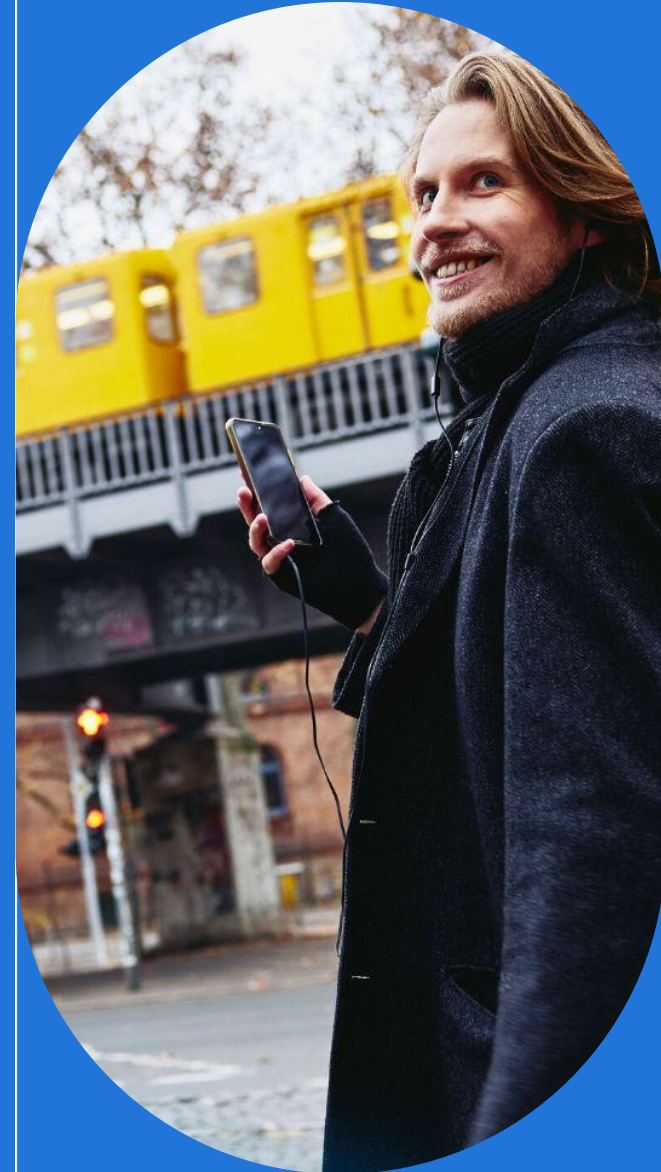
do you currently work remotely/from home?



Around 3 in 5 talent in India work remotely at least some of the time, while the remaining talent tend to work fully on-site. This suggests that remote working is now embedded in the labour market, but not evenly available to everyone. For many, flexibility has become part of normal working life, while a sizeable group remains tied to the workplace, likely reflecting differences in role feasibility and workplace set-up.

The pattern differs by generation and gender. Gen Z and Millennials are more likely to work remotely at least partly (63% vs. 62%) than Gen X (51%), with hybrid working more common among younger talent (44% each vs. 34%). Women are also more likely than men to work remotely at least partly (65% vs. 56%), while men are more likely to work fully on-site (29% vs. 22%).

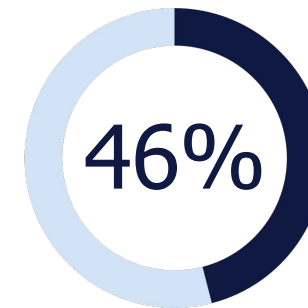
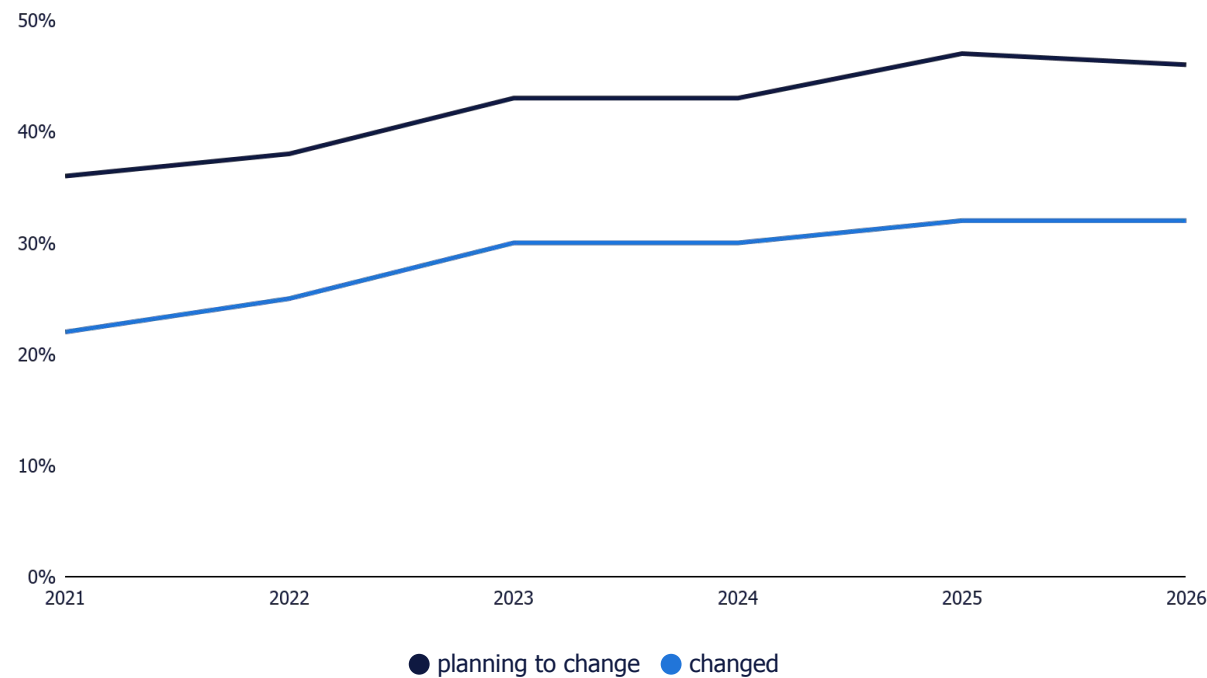
job-switching behaviour in focus.



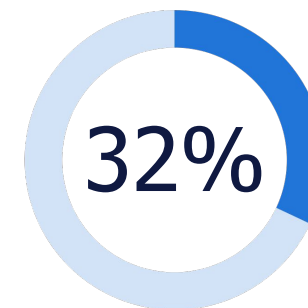
job switching behaviour over time.

intentions to change jobs in India remain higher than actual mobility, with nearly half of employees planning a move compared to only around a third who have recently changed employer.

have changed employer in the last 6 months



is planning to change jobs within the first 6 months of 2026



have changed employer in the last 6 months of 2025

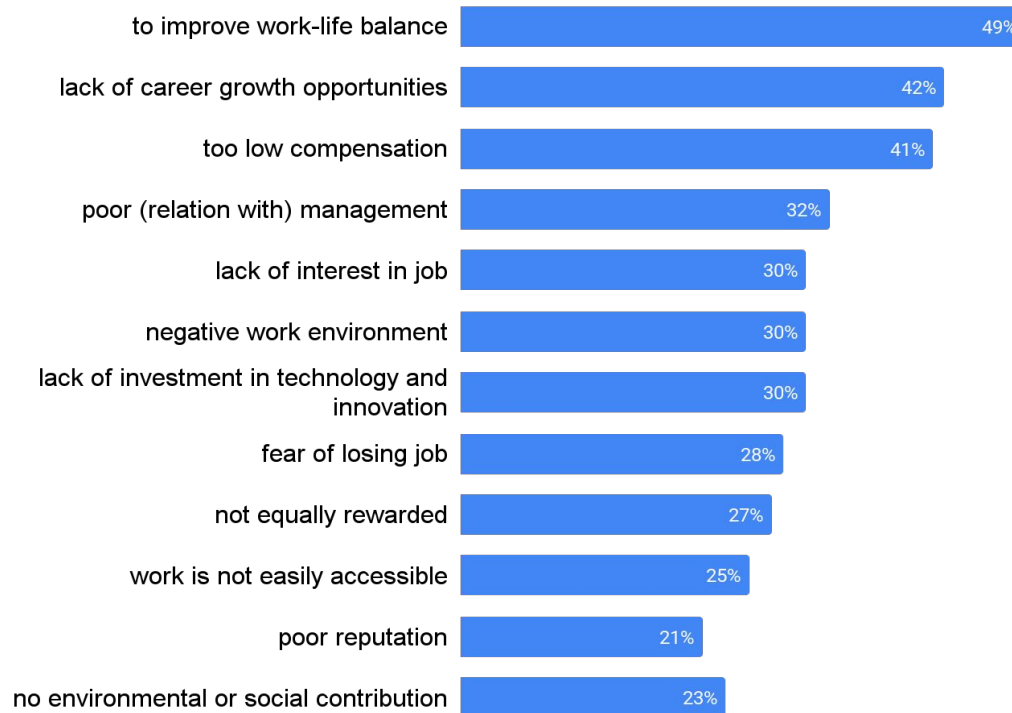


Q. Did you change jobs in the last 6 months?
Q. Do you plan to change jobs within the next 6 months?

what are the most important reasons to leave?

work-life balance concerns stand out as the leading reason talent would leave their employer in India.

reasons for leaving



Career growth and too low compensation form the next tier of exit drivers, showing that retention pressure in India is shaped by balance, future progression and fair reward. Poor leadership and relationships with management follow next, adding the wider employer experience to the retention story.

The pattern is broadly consistent across generations, though work-life balance concerns are slightly stronger among Gen Z and Millennials (50% and 51%) than Gen X (46%). Career growth also carries slightly more weight among Millennials (43% vs. 39% Gen X), while compensation remains steady across generations (42%, 41%, 41%).

Gender differences are limited: women are slightly more likely to leave for work-life balance (51% vs. 49%), while men place slightly more weight on career growth (43% vs. 41%) and compensation (42% vs. 40%).



how does it relate to current situation?

the main reasons for leaving show a mixed relationship with how these aspects are evaluated in the current employer.

reasons to leave

1. to improve work-life balance
2. lack of career growth opportunities
3. too low compensation
4. poor (relation with) management
5. lack of interest in job
6. negative work environment
7. lack of investment in technology and innovation
8. fear of losing job
9. not equally rewarded
10. work is not easily accessible
11. poor reputation
12. no environmental or social contribution

evaluation of current employer

1. very good reputation
2. strong management/leadership
3. easy access to work
4. equal opportunities
5. career progression
6. work-life balance
7. job security
8. interesting job content
9. pleasant work atmosphere
10. salary & benefits
11. state-of-the-art technology
12. benefits the environment and society

Work-life balance is the leading reason to leave (49%), followed by career growth (42%), despite both receiving strong positive ratings in the evaluation of the current employer. Poor relationships with management also emerge as a key driver of exit , even though management and leadership are rated positively overall, highlighting how sensitive these areas are when expectations are not met.

By contrast, salary and benefits, as well as lack of interest in the job, align more closely with lower-performing areas.

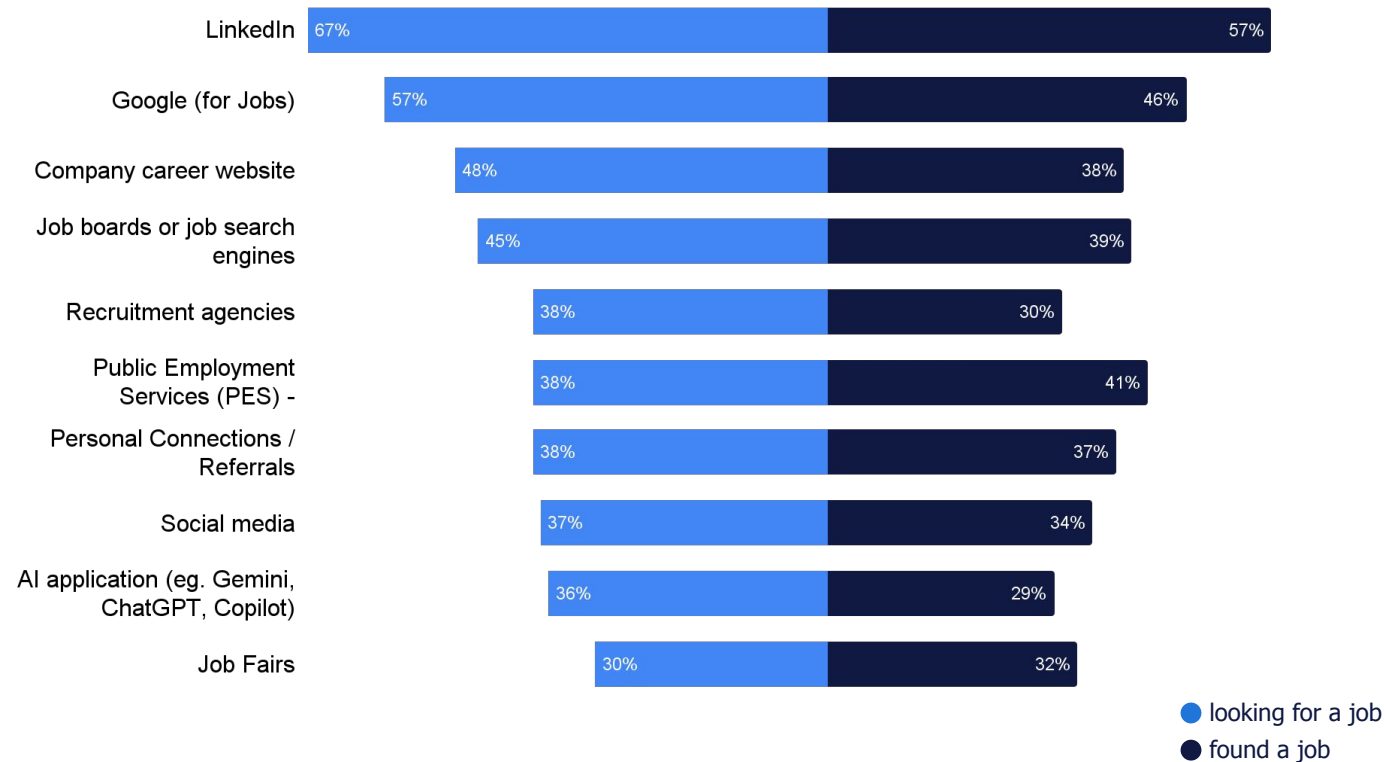
Overall, employers perform better on reputation, leadership and fairness, while retention pressure is more concentrated around reward, growth and work-life balance.



sources used to find new opportunities

LinkedIn leads both job search and successful job outcomes in India, with Google for Jobs as the strongest supporting route.

sources for job opportunities



Company career websites and job boards form the next layer of the search journey, showing that talent in India rely on a mix of employer-led and structured platforms when exploring opportunities. Public Employment Services also stand out for their successful job outcomes, suggesting that, alongside digital routes, more formal channels still play an important role in converting searches into hires.

Search behaviour is strongest among Millennials on LinkedIn (69% vs. 68% Gen Z and 61% Gen X), Google for Jobs (59% vs. 58% and 49%), company career websites (52% vs. 48% and 38%) and job boards (49% vs. 43% and 37%).

Millennials also convert more strongly through LinkedIn (61% vs. 57% and 48%) and Google for Jobs (50% vs. 46% and 36%).

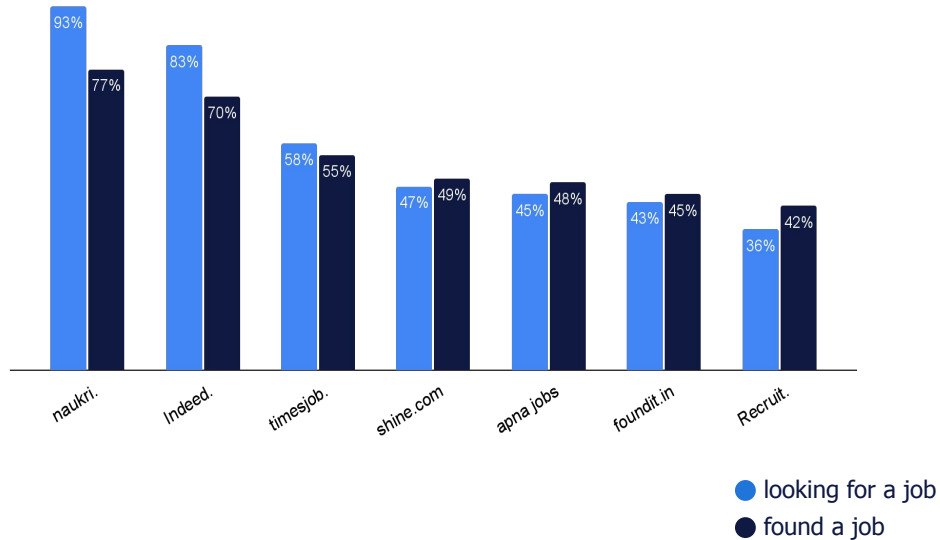


Q. Through which of the following job search channels have you used to look for a job?
Q. Through which of the following job search channels did you find a job?

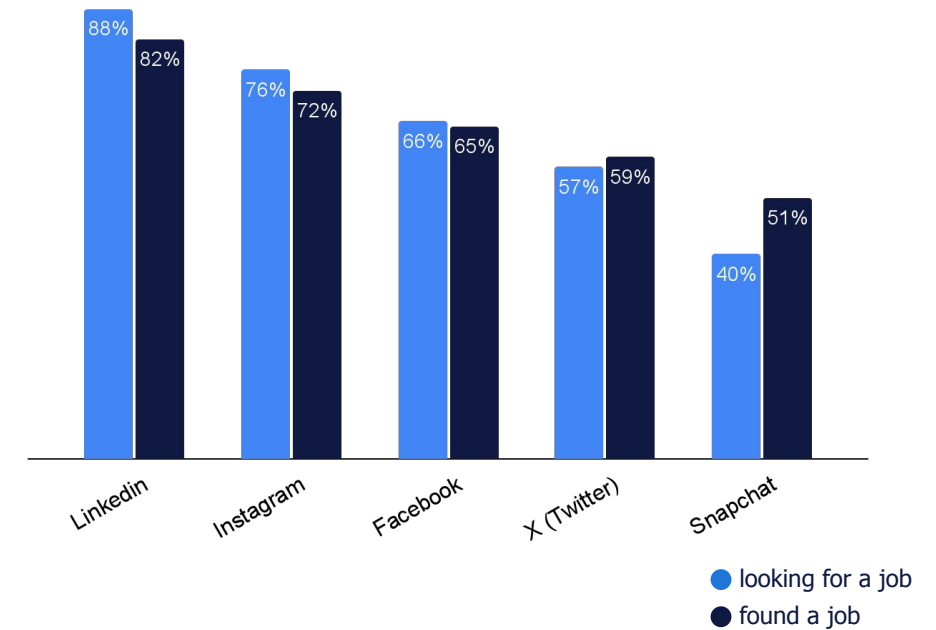
job portals and social media channels used throughout the job search.

In India, Naukri and Indeed are the leading job portals for both search and job finding, while LinkedIn and Instagram are the strongest social media channels. X and Snapchat, are more often associated with finding a job than with actively searching, suggesting they serve as passive discovery channels during the job search.

job portals



social media

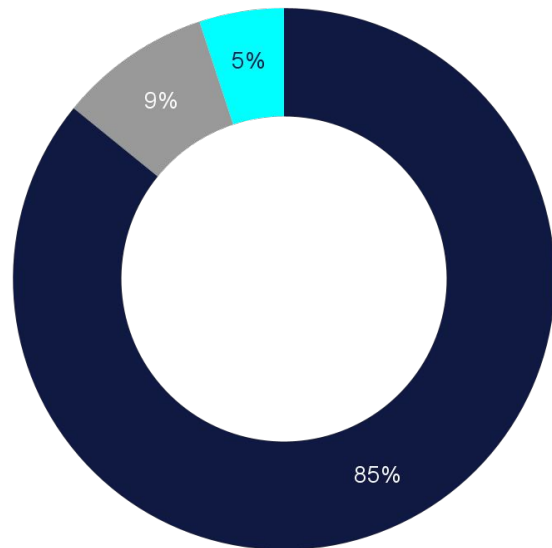


Q. Through which of these job boards/ job search engines or social media did you find a job?
Q. Which of the following job boards/job search engines or social media have you used to look for a job?

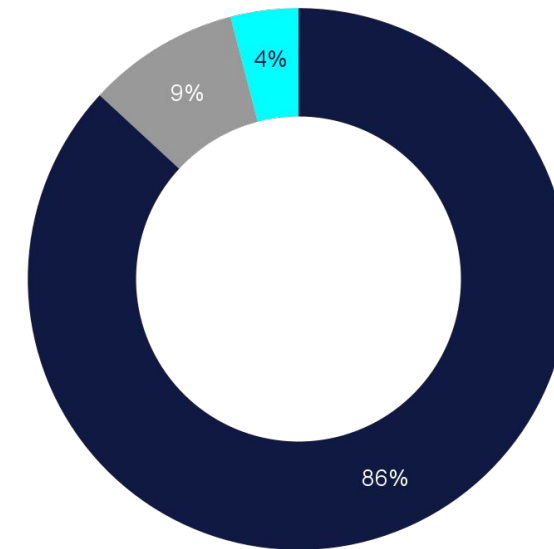
importance of in person contact.

in-person contact remains highly important to talent in India throughout the job search journey. Its role becomes slightly stronger (+1%) at the application stage.

when exploring for jobs



when applying for jobs



● (very) important
● neutral
● not (at all) important



appendix.

top employers.



top 3 EVP drivers of the top employers in india.

top employers in India are anchored in good reputation, with technology, leadership and career progression helping distinguish their appeal.

top companies

	1	2	3
1. Google India	good reputation	state-of-the-art technology	career progression
2. Tata Group	good reputation	strong management/leadership	interesting job content
3. Amazon	good reputation	interesting job content	state-of-the-art technology
4. Samsung India	good reputation	state-of-the-art technology	interesting job content
5. Infosys	good reputation	career progression	state-of-the-art technology
6. Reliance Industries	good reputation	strong management/leadership	career progression
7. ITC Group	good reputation	state-of-the-art technology	strong management/leadership
8. Hindustan Unilever	good reputation	strong management/leadership	interesting job content
9. Mahindra & Mahindra	good reputation	career progression	strong management/leadership
10. Dell Technologies Ltd	good reputation	state-of-the-art technology	good work-life balance



Q. Based on your impression of the employers below, to what extent would you like to work for them?

Q. You will now see a number of statements. Please evaluate each of the following employers on a scale from 1 to 5 for each of these statements.

background
information.



34 markets surveyed covering more than 75% of the global economy.



argentina	chile	hungary	the netherlands	spain
australia	china	india	new zealand	sweden
austria	czech republic	italy	norway	switzerland
belgium	france	japan	poland	united kingdom
brazil	germany	luxembourg	portugal	united states
canada	greece	malaysia	romania	uruguay
denmark	hong kong SAR	mexico	singapore	

sample

- aged 18 to retirement age representative on gender overrepresentation of age 25 – 44 comprised of students, employed and unemployed workforce

fieldwork

- online interviews

length of interview

- 14 minutes

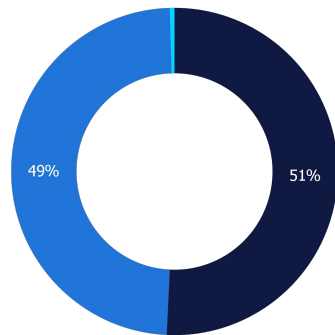
sample country

- india, 3499

sample composition in india

socio-demographics, education, region.

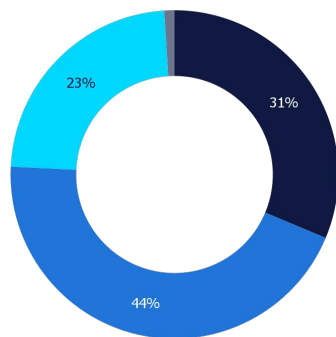
gender



- male
- female
- other*

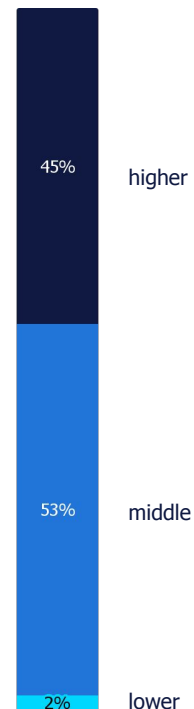
* other is comprised of all other gender identities and people who prefer not to answer the question

age

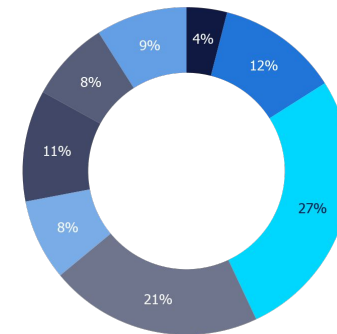


- Gen Z (1997-2012)
- Millennials (1981-1996)
- Gen X (1965-1980)
- Baby boomers (1946-1964)

education



region



- Ahmedabad (Gujarat)
- Bangalore (Karnataka)
- Delhi/NCR (Haryana/Punjab)
- Mumbai & Pune (Maharashtra)
- Chennai (Tamil Nadu)
- Kolkata (West Bengal)
- Hyderabad (Andhra Pradesh)
- Rest of India

A decorative graphic on the left side of the slide. It features a horizontal white line. Above and below this line are several vertical bars of varying heights and colors: blue, cyan, and white. Some bars have small circles at their top or bottom, in colors matching the bars or the background.

your thoughts.

let's start a conversation

Our research has many insightful, but complex insights so we'd love the opportunity to walk you through this document, share our thoughts and answer any questions you might have.

[randstad india](#)

Cauvery Uthappa

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thank
you.



partner for talent.